

Structural Paper Review
To be completed Friday 3/20

The purpose of this exercise is to explore how structural estimation techniques are utilized in your area of interest. The first part of the assignment is to identify a paper in your field that aims to estimate economic primitives using structural techniques – including topics or estimation approaches we have not yet covered (dynamics, learning, GMM, etc.). Ideally the paper is relatively recent, say within the past three years (job market papers are often good candidates). The paper can be published or not. Please send me your candidate paper no later than 3/10.

Once you have identified your paper, the next step is to deconstruct the paper. The following is a suggested outline for things I want you to cover.

- Brief summary of the research question and relevance
- Describe why the authors pursue a structural approach and contrast it with what a reduced-form approach might look like
- Discuss the behavioral model and how it relates to the empirical framework
- Discuss key econometric modeling assumptions (functional forms, distributional assumptions, state-space restrictions), the restrictions these assumptions impose, and whether it would be easy to relax these assumptions
- Describe in detail the estimation approach. What are the key computational challenges?
- Describe the counterfactual analyses. Would these be possible in a reduced form model? Are there other interesting counterfactuals you would want to see?
- Provide an overall evaluation of the paper, discussing open questions and areas for improvement. If you were going to extend the paper, what would you do?

The write-up should be 3-5 pages. Please turn in a pdf of your write-up along with the original paper.